Goku's Five Strongest Dragon Ball Forms, Ranked

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Dragon Ball is one of the most famous **anime franchises** in the world. Created by Akira Toriyama more than 40 years ago, it shaped countless shows that came after it. Its hero, Goku, is hungry, hardworking and always getting stronger. A writer for the website /Film has ranked Goku's five strongest forms.

Number five is Super Saiyan God, first seen in the movie Dragon Ball Z: Battle of Gods. Goku cannot reach it alone. Five Saiyans must share their energy, called **ki**, with him in a special **ritual**. His hair and eyes turn red, and he can predict his opponent's moves. But at first he could only keep the form for a short time.

Next comes Super Saiyan Blue Kaio-ken. Kaio-ken is an old **technique** that boosts Goku's speed and power. Combining it with Super Saiyan Blue makes him even stronger, but it was so hard to control that it left him weak and tired for days. Because of that downside, the writer ranks it lower.

Third is Super Saiyan Blue. Goku's hair and eyes turn bright blue, and he gains a crackling electric glow. It became his main power-up throughout Dragon Ball Super.

Second is Ultra Instinct Sign, which Goku unlocked during the Tournament of Power. His hair gets silver highlights, and his eyes turn silver. Instead of a new supernatural look, this form relies on **martial arts** skill. Goku reacts instantly to attacks and can dodge without much thought.

At the top is Perfected Ultra Instinct. It let Goku defeat the powerful fighter Jiren. It needs a perfectly calm mind and uses lots of energy. But the writer says Goku can keep training it, so its power may have no limit.

Word Treasure

anime -- A style of animated shows and movies that comes from Japan.

franchise -- A group of shows, movies, games and products that all share the same story and characters.

ki -- In Dragon Ball, the inner energy that characters use to power up and fight.

ritual -- A special set of actions done in a certain order for a purpose.

technique -- A special way of doing something that takes skill to learn.

martial arts -- Fighting skills and sports, such as karate or kung fu, that take years of training.

Background you need

Dragon Ball began as a Japanese comic, called manga, before becoming animated TV series, movies and games watched around the world.

In the story, Goku is a Saiyan, a powerful warrior race whose members can transform into stronger forms.

Each new transformation usually appears when Goku faces a tougher opponent, which keeps the story building toward bigger battles.

Fans often debate which form is strongest because each one has different strengths and drawbacks, such as how much energy it uses.

Break it down

LEAD: A /Film writer ranks Goku's five strongest Dragon Ball forms
CONTEXT: Dragon Ball, created by Akira Toriyama, shaped many anime that came after it
RANKING:

+- #5 Super Saiyan God: needs five Saiyans' ki; red hair and eyes; predicts moves
+- #4 Super Saiyan Blue Kaio-ken: stronger but left Goku weak for days
+- #3 Super Saiyan Blue: bright blue hair, electric glow; main power-up in Dragon Ball Super
+- #2 Ultra Instinct Sign: silver eyes; relies on martial arts skill and instant reactions
+- #1 Perfected Ultra Instinct: beat Jiren; needs a calm mind

OPEN QUESTION: Since Goku can keep training, how strong could his top form become?

Why it matters

Dragon Ball's ideas about training, focus and growth have shaped anime around the world, and ranking the forms shows how the story rewards hard work and a calm mind.

Test what you remember

1. Who created Dragon Ball?

- (A) Jiren
- (B) Akira Toriyama
- (C) Steven Spielberg
- (D) Beerus

2. What must happen for Goku to reach Super Saiyan God?

- (A) Five Saiyans must share their energy with him in a ritual
- (B) He must eat a special meal
- (C) He must win a tournament
- (D) He must train alone for a year

3. What color do Goku's hair and eyes turn in Super Saiyan Blue?

- (A) Red
- (B) Bright blue
- (C) Silver
- (D) Gold

4. Why does the writer rank Super Saiyan Blue Kaio-ken lower?

- (A) Goku never used it
- (B) It looks boring
- (C) It only works in movies
- (D) It was so hard to control that it left Goku weak and tired for days

5. During which event did Goku unlock Ultra Instinct Sign?

- (A) The Saiyan ritual
- (B) Battle of Gods
- (C) The World Games
- (D) The Tournament of Power

6. Which form is ranked number one?

- (A) Perfected Ultra Instinct
- (B) Super Saiyan God
- (C) Super Saiyan Blue
- (D) Ultra Instinct Sign

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: A 3: B 4: D 5: D 6: A

Questions to think about

1. /Film writer: Ranks Perfected Ultra Instinct first because Goku can keep training it, and places Super Saiyan Blue Kaio-ken lower because of its downsides.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):